MODULE 1

CHAPTER 3

Education & Enablement

One of the key lessons that has emerged from those companies on the leading edge of AI adoption has been that preparing your employees to be ready for and able to use AI is vital to successful adoption.

The companies that have been successful have shown that a robust program of education and enablement for your employees is a requirement, not an option. Simple AI orientation meetings will not get the job done.

What You'll Learn

- What the goals of Education & Enablement are
- Some key roles to target
- How to leverage your key partners
- Why and how to engage your full community
- How to build a simple but valuable program on a budget

Why Education & Enablement Matter

AI adoption, like all technology adoption, succeeds or fails on the basis of one key factor: people. Even with the right strategy, platforms, and governance, progress stalls if teams aren't mentally and practically ready to work with AI.

Education & Enablement are about building confidence in your employees, not just compliance with the rules. They focus on helping every employee understand why change is happening, what it means for them, and how they can actively participate.

Practical Steps to Launch Your Program

Follow these steps to build momentum and ensure your AI education program delivers real results.

1. **Assess Readiness:** Survey your teams to identify their knowledge gaps and concerns.
2. **Map Training to Personas:** Align content and delivery with the needs of each role leveraging AI.
3. **Leverage Existing Resources:** Use internal platforms and vendor offerings to avoid duplication.
4. **Track Progress:** Integrate learning milestones into team meetings and development plans.

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Celebrate Success: Recognize individuals and teams who embrace AI and share their wins.

Building Your AI Education Program

A successful AI adoption strategy requires education at every level—from frontline teams to executives—and extends beyond your organization to include partners, customers, and the broader community you serve. The good news? You don't need a massive budget to make it happen.

Focus on three practical delivery methods that don't require a large budget:

- **Microlearning** — Short 5-10 minute modules that fit busy schedules
- **Peer-Led Training** — Empower early adopters to share tips with colleagues
- **Vendor Resources** — Leverage materials from partners like Calix University

The matrix below shows how to match these formats to the right topics and audiences.

Training Topic	👥 Frontline Teams	💻 Technical Teams
AI Fundamentals Core concepts & safe use	**Essential** Microlearning + Vendor	**Essential** Microlearning + Vendor
Role-Specific Applications AI tools for daily workflows	**Essential** Peer-Led + Vendor	**Essential** Vendor Resources
Integration & Data Readiness Deployment & security	**Recommended** Peer-Led	**Essential** Peer-Led + Vendor
	Recommended	**Recommended**

Governance & Strategy Adoption & measuring impact	Microlearning	Peer-Led

Best Practice: Leverage Key Partners

Include your key partners in your education & enablement initiatives, whether they're technology vendors, consultants, or ecosystem collaborators. Calix is one prime example of such a partner, but it's certain you have others that you can and do rely on. Leverage these key partners in this work as they are undoubtedly on a similar journey and would be eager, as Calix is, to help you in any way they can. This ensures all of your key business and technology partners are aligned and working together for you on best practices, security, and shared outcomes.

AI Readiness Self-Assessment

This self-assessment is a short, reflective activity designed to help you pause and take stock of where you currently stand with AI at work. Rather than testing right or wrong answers, it explores your familiarity with common AI tools, your comfort level using them, and your curiosity about applying AI in real workplace situations.

SELF-ASSESSMENT TOOL

AI Readiness Self-Assessment

This short activity will give you insight into where you are on your AI journey — and how to make the most of this training.

1. **Complete the Self-Assessment**
   10 questions · ~3 minutes
2. **Receive Your AI Persona**
   One of 4 profiles matched to you
3. **Get Personalized Learning Tips**
   Curated for your starting point

Begin Assessment →

Ready-to-Use Training Resources

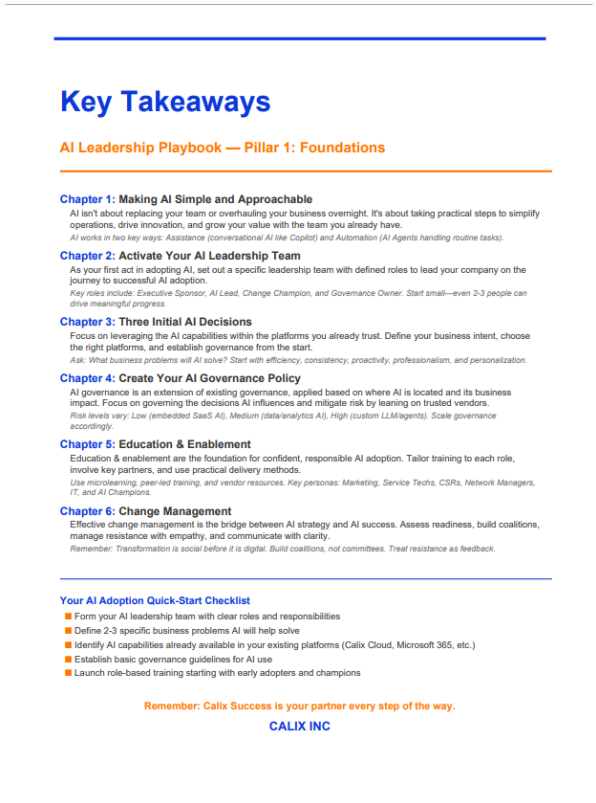
You don't have to build your AI education program from scratch. Below are three foundational resources you can use right away to jumpstart your team's AI fluency—a self-assessment to surface where each person stands, a glossary to establish shared vocabulary, and a microlearning course to build core understanding. Share these with your team to create a common starting point for your AI journey.

PDF DOWNLOAD

Essential Terms & Definitions

A printable glossary covering key AI concepts, terminology, and definitions around AI.

Download PDF



Key Takeaways

AI Leadership Playbook — Pillar 1: Foundations

Chapter 1: Making AI Simple and Approachable
AI isn't about replacing your team or overhauling your business overnight. It's about taking practical steps to simplify operations, drive innovation, and grow your value with the team you already have.
AI works in two key ways: Assistance (conversational AI like Copilot) and Automation (AI Agents handling routine tasks).

Chapter 2: Activate Your AI Leadership Team
As your first act in adopting AI, set out a specific leadership team with defined roles to lead your company on the journey to successful AI adoption.
Key roles include: Executive Sponsor, AI Lead, Change Champion, and Governance Owner. Start small—even 2-3 people can drive meaningful progress.

Chapter 3: Three Initial AI Decisions
Focus on leveraging the AI capabilities within the platforms you already trust. Define your business intent, choose the right platforms, and establish governance from the start.
Ask: What business problems will AI solve? Start with efficiency, consistency, proactivity, professionalism, and personalization.

Chapter 4: Create Your AI Governance Policy
AI governance is an extension of existing governance, applied based on where AI is located and its business impact. Focus on governing the decisions AI influences and mitigate risk by leaning on trusted vendors.
Risk levels vary: Low (embedded SaaS AI), Medium (data/analytics AI), High (custom LLM/agents). Scale governance accordingly.

Chapter 5: Education & Enablement
Education & enablement are the foundation for confident, responsible AI adoption. Tailor training to each role, involve key partners, and use practical delivery methods.
Use microlearning, peer-led training, and vendor resources. Key personas: Marketing, Service Techs, CSRs, Network Managers, IT, and AI Champions.

Chapter 6: Change Management
Effective change management is the bridge between AI strategy and AI success. Assess readiness, build coalitions, manage resistance with empathy, and communicate with clarity.
Remember: Transformation is social before it is digital. Build coalitions, not committees. Treat resistance as feedback.

Your AI Adoption Quick-Start Checklist
- Form your AI leadership team with clear roles and responsibilities
- Define 2-3 specific business problems AI will help solve
- Identify AI capabilities already available in your existing platforms (Calix Cloud, Microsoft 365, etc.)
- Establish basic governance guidelines for AI use
- Launch role-based training starting with early adopters and champions

Remember: Calix Success is your partner every step of the way.

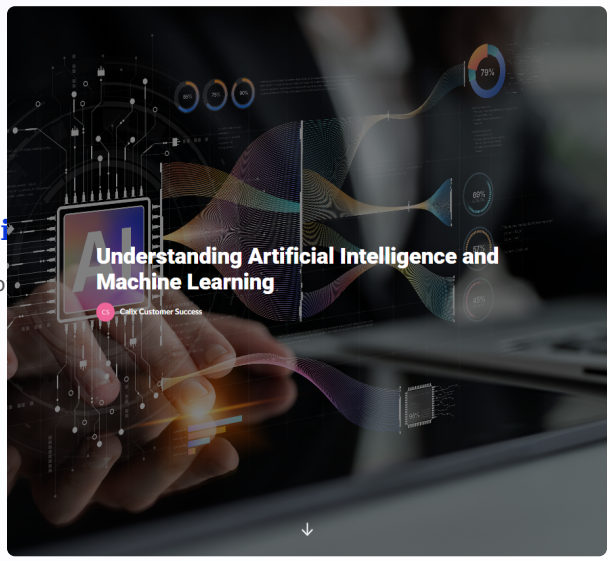
CALIX INC

MICROLEARNING COURSE

Understanding Artificial Intelligence and Machi

In just a few minutes, learners will explore what AI actually is, where it sho
intelligence.

🎓 Launch Course



These resources are just the beginning. As your team grows more confident with AI fundamentals, you can expand your training library to address role-specific applications and advanced use cases. The key is to start now—every step forward builds momentum for your organization's AI journey.

Chapter Takeaway

The education & enablement you give your people can be the foundation for confident, responsible AI adoption across your company. By tailoring training to each role, involving key partners, and using practical delivery methods, you can empower your company to move from awareness to mastery—turning AI from a source of anxiety into a driver of innovation and value.